

Agentic Payment Settlement — Options & Challenges

Dhiyos · prepared for founder discussion · June 2026

Goal. When the agent books a cart, the platform should pay *each merchant* the exact amount shown on screen, automatically (off-session), after a one-time user authorization — with the **AP2 protocol** providing signed proof of intent, cart and payment. The blocker is not AP2 (already built and working); it is the **money-movement rail** available to an India-registered platform.

The problem has two halves

A · USER → AGENT (AUTO-DEDUCTION)	B · PLATFORM → MERCHANT (SETTLEMENT)
Let the user authorize once, then allow the agent to pay on their behalf later, without the user present.	Route each merchant's exact share into <i>their own</i> bank account — not the platform's.

Most rails solve only one half well. A production system combines an auto-deduction rail (A) with a split-settlement rail (B).

Where we are today (built & tested)

AP2 + Stripe (per-merchant charges)

- One-time card authorization via Stripe `SetupIntent` (off-session) — the AP2 Payment Mandate.
- On booking: real, signed AP2 mandates (Intent → per-merchant Cart → Payment) + one off-session Stripe charge *per merchant* for the exact amount, each verifiable (we confirmed live charges + receipts).
- Limitation:** all funds land in *our* Stripe balance. Merchants are attributed via metadata + a settlement ledger + signed receipt, but money is **not** deposited into each merchant's bank.

WORKING IN TEST

Options for true settlement (Half B)

1 · Stripe Connect

The "correct" Stripe answer: connected account per merchant + destination charges, each merchant paid directly.

Challenge: India-registered platforms cannot onboard as Stripe Connect platforms (regulatory/identity verification). Not viable for us.

BLOCKED FOR INDIA

2 · Per-merchant charges + ledger (current)

Keep Stripe, charge each merchant's exact amount to our account, track attribution in a ledger + AP2 receipt.

Challenge: money never reaches the merchants' banks — fine for a prototype, not for real operations. Currency is USD in test (₹ amounts mirror the numbers).

DEMO-GRADE

3 · Razorpay Route / Cashfree Easy Split

India marketplace rails: one customer payment is split and **settled directly to each merchant's bank/UPI**; platform deducts commission. Route's "Linked Accounts" map almost 1:1 onto our per-merchant step.

Challenges: each merchant must be a real, **KYC'd** entity with a bank account (real onboarding); INR-only; requires business verification / sales enablement (not instant self-serve); only the payment-execution step changes — AP2 layer stays.

INDIA-NATIVE SPLIT

Options for auto-deduction (Half A)

Card / UPI e-mandate

CAPPED + DELAYED

- User authorizes once (OTP/3DS); agent debits later up to a cap.
- **Challenges:** per-txn OTP above ~₹15,000; **24-hour pre-debit notification** required by RBI before each auto-debit → *breaks instant checkout*.

PPI wallet (Razorpay Engage)

INSTANT OFF-SESSION

- User pre-funds a wallet once; agent spends from **balance** instantly — no per-txn OTP, no 24h notice.
- **Challenges:** see licensing below; KYC limits (min-KYC ≈ ₹10k, full-KYC ≤ ₹2,00,000).

PPI wallet — the licensing fork

WALLET TYPE	CAN PAY...	RBI LICENSE?
Closed	only Dhiyos (we are merchant-of-record)	NONE NEEDED
Semi-closed	multiple third-party merchants	FULL PPI LICENSE (India co., ₹15–25 cr net worth, RBI authorization, audits)
Partner / BaaS	third-party merchants, on a licensed issuer's licence	NO LICENCE FOR US — ride partner (e.g. Razorpay Engage)

A marketplace paying external merchants is **semi-closed** → needs a licence or a licensed partner. A closed wallet only works if Dhiyos is the seller-of-record. PPI solves Half A beautifully but the merchant payout (Half B) still needs Route / Easy Split.

Recommendation

Prototype (now, no licence): keep AP2 + a *closed-loop wallet* (internal balance ledger funded via a Razorpay payment, debited instantly by the agent). Demonstrates the full instant agentic-checkout experience legally.

Production: Razorpay Route for real split settlement to merchant banks (smallest change from our current per-merchant step) + an auto-deduction rail — UPI Autopay / e-mandate for standing orders, or a **BaaS PPI wallet** (Razorpay Engage) for instant agent spend. AP2 stays unchanged across all of these; only the execution step swaps.

Open decisions for founder: (1) Are we merchant-of-record or a true marketplace? (2) Appetite for KYC onboarding of merchants? (3) Instant agent checkout (needs wallet) vs scheduled orders (e-mandate is fine)?

Limits and RBI rules change periodically — verify current caps and licensing thresholds before committing. Prepared as a discussion aid, not legal/financial advice.